

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 35 Summary

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In this lesson, we focus on helping beginners speak Spanish right away using **plug-and-play sentence starters**. These are patterns where you only need to plug in an infinitive (the base form of the verb). No need to conjugate both verbs—just one.

Core Sentence Starters (YO = I)

These are sentence patterns where the subject is **yo** (I), and you simply add an infinitive:

Quiero + infinitive – I want to

Tengo que + infinitive – I have to

Puedo + infinitive – I can / Can I...?

Debería + infinitive – I should

Podría + infinitive – I could

Voy a + infinitive – I'm going to

Acabo de + infinitive – I just did

Examples:

- *Quiero dormir.* – I want to sleep.
 - *Tengo que estudiar.* – I have to study.
 - *Puedo salir.* – I can go. / Can I leave?
 - *Debería leer más.* – I should read more.
 - *Voy a acostarme.* – I'm going to go to bed.
 - *Acabo de despertarme.* – I just woke up.
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Using Pronominal Verbs with “Me”

If the infinitive ends in **–se**, you'll need to change “se” to match the subject pronoun. When using “yo,” replace **se** with **me**:

- *dormirse* → *dormirme* → *Quiero dormirme.* – I want to fall asleep.
- *acostarse* → *acostarme* → *Voy a acostarme.* – I'm going to go to bed.
- *levantarse* → *levantarme* → *Tengo que levantarme.* – I have to get up.

Same Sentence Starters with the TÚ Form (You)

Now let's look at the same plug-and-play patterns from above but with **tú** (you) as the subject. The conjugated part changes to match second-person singular (informal "you"), but the infinitive still stays the same.

Quieres + infinitive – You want to

Tienes que + infinitive – You have to

Puedes + infinitive – You can / Can you...?

Deberías + infinitive – You should

Podrías + infinitive – You could

Vas a + infinitive – You're going to

Acabas de + infinitive – You just did

Examples:

- *¿Quieres comer?* – Do you want to eat?
- *Tienes que estudiar.* – You have to study.
- *¿Puedes salir?* – Can you go out?
- *Deberías dormir más.* – You should sleep more.
- *Vas a levantarte temprano.* – You're going to get up early.
- *Acabas de acostarte.* – You just went to bed.

Using Pronominal Verbs with "Te"

When you use **tú** as the subject, change the **-se** on pronominal verbs to **te**:

- *dormirse* → *dormirte* → *¿Quieres dormirte?* – Do you want to fall asleep?
- *acostarse* → *acostarte* → *Vas a acostarte.* – You're going to go to bed.
- *levantarse* → *levantarte* → *Tienes que levantarte.* – You have to get up.

Closing Thoughts

These sentence starters are one of the fastest ways to start communicating in Spanish. They let you build complete thoughts with minimal conjugation and maximum flexibility.

Start with “yo” phrases, then branch into “tú” forms to ask questions or give advice. Practice swapping in new infinitives and getting used to reflexive pronoun changes with **me** and **te**.

Once you get this down, you’ll be able to say more than most beginners—and do it confidently. Keep plugging them in.